



DEPARTMENT OF
DATA AND SYSTEMS ENGINEERING
The University of Hong Kong

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The DASE Beamer template

A guide to its design, features and editable
examples

Your Name

October 2026



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1

Design and navigation

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One theme, your lab's presentation

This deck is both a user guide and a collection of editable examples

A shared identity

DASE branding, an HKU crest watermark and one orange chevron connect the opening, chapter and closing pages.

Your team's identity

Replace the lab logo image. It appears beneath DASE on all three page types and scales automatically.

Built-in boundaries

Oversized headings end with an ellipsis. Their font size stays fixed and the content stays inside its placeholder.

Find each example in `template.tex`; the visual rules live in `beamerthemeDASE.sty`.

Use the named colours directly in text, diagrams and plots

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#562B82

Structure



#E25825

Attention



#40B488

Examples



#6684BE

Supporting data



#FFD532

Highlights

HKUink provides dark body text; DASEslate supports captions. DASEpaper and DASEmist provide the light backgrounds.

`\textcolor{DASEpurple}{Your text}` Your text

Purple anchors the layout. Orange marks warnings and the current slide. Green and blue distinguish examples and data.

Page types and the progress footer

Three special pages

- ▶ **Title:** purple panel, title and subtitle.
- ▶ **Chapter:** light panel, number centred beside the chapter title.
- ▶ **Thank you:** purple panel, editable closing message.

Content pages

Dark headings, an optional subtitle and a light canvas leave the main area for your results. Blocks, lists, tables and figures share the palette.

All three special pages carry the DASE mark, your lab logo and the crest watermark.

Read the footer below

Author/institute | grouped progress dots | chapter name | content-slide number. Purple dots are completed; orange is current; outlines are upcoming. Click a dot to jump to its slide. Gaps separate chapters.

Plain pages and unnumbered frames are excluded; overlays share a dot. Compile twice after changing the slide order.



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2 Build your slides

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Three block environments communicate three different roles

Three block environments communicate three different roles

Use `block` for a definition, method or main claim.

- ▶ A primary point.
- ▶ A supporting point.
 - A short sub-point.

Use `exampleblock` for an illustration, working example or observation.

- 1 Define the input.
- 2 Run the method.
- 3 Compare the result.

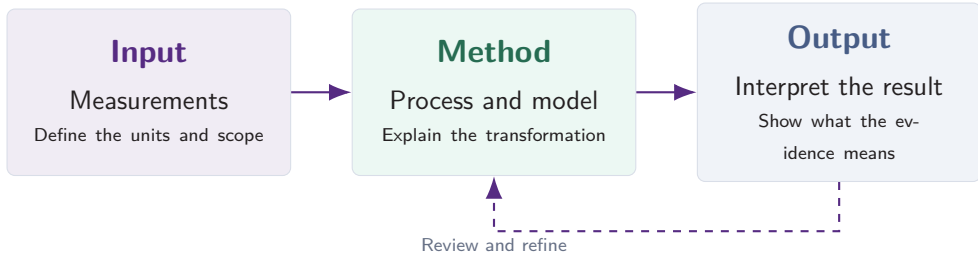
Use alertblock for a limitation, risk or action that needs attention.

Use **bold** for a key phrase and `\alert{...}` for orange emphasis.

Block headings also truncate automatically. Block bodies remain your responsibility: shorten them or split the slide.

A TikZ figure that uses the theme colours

Vector diagrams stay sharp; labels and arrows remain editable in the source



Reuse this figure

Edit the nodes and edges in this frame's `tikzpicture`. Use `DASEpurple`, `DASEgreen` and `DASEblue` instead of hard-coded colours.

A readable code snippet

Use a fragile frame for literal code; keep the example focused

```
def normalise(values):
    """Scale a sequence to the range [0, 1]."""
    low, high = min(values), max(values)
    if high == low:
        return [0.0 for _ in values]
    return [(x - low) / (high - low)
            for x in values]
```

Explain the useful part

The constant-input case avoids division by zero. The remaining values share a common scale.

The snippet is literal text, not executed code. Edit it directly in `template.tex`.

Code lines do not use title truncation. Break long lines explicitly.

Examples use illustrative data, not research results

booktabs supplies the rules. Put units in column headings and highlight only the values that support your point.

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Citations and references are already connected

Use numbered citations in the text and a bibliography at the end

- ▶ Show quantitative evidence on readable scales [1].
- ▶ Match the visual encoding to the data and task [2].
- ▶ Move from an overview to relevant details [3].

Replace the example sources

Edit `bib.bib`; cite an entry with `\cite{key}`. The final references page lists the cited entries. Citation numbers and DOI links are clickable.

Rerun Biber when citations or bibliography entries change. The references frame allows page breaks when the list grows.

The next chapter deliberately uses oversized text to demonstrate the safeguards

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Theme placeholder	Automatic behaviour
Slide title / subtitle	One line, then an ellipsis.
Cover title / subtitle	At most two lines, then an ellipsis.
Chapter title	At most two lines; number stays vertically centred.
Block heading / footer fields	One line, then an ellipsis.

The original font size stays fixed

The full text remains in your source. The theme shortens only its visible presentation; shorter wording is still better for your audience.

Paragraphs, code, tables and figures are authored normally. These safeguards apply to the theme's text placeholders.



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Handling oversized chapter titles and...

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Practical IP based traffic generation for larg...

This deliberately oversized subtitle continues well beyond the available heading width...

Live example: an oversized slide title and subtitle

Look at the two heading lines above: both end with an ellipsis, at their normal font sizes. The long chapter name in the footer is shortened too.

Full title supplied in the source

Practical IP based traffic generation for large distributed systems with complex conditional behaviour and long term temporal dependencies

What to do in your own deck

Edit the argument of `\begin{frame}{...}` or `\frametitle{...}`. Shorten the wording when the hidden ending matters.

An unbroken identifier and an oversized block heading are bounded too

The heading is shortened; this body text remains untouched. The same rule applies to standard, example and alert block headings.

The title above is a single long identifier. The theme can truncate text at character boundaries instead of allowing it to run into the margin.

This example block title is deliberately...

A column's block heading uses that column's available width.

The following page is a live cover demo, not a second presentation

The following page is a live cover demo, not a second presentation

A title and subtitle that need more than two lines. Each stops after its second line and ends with an ellipsis. Author and date remain in their own areas.

A title and subtitle that need more than two lines. Each stops after its second line and ends with an ellipsis. Author and date remain in their own areas.

The chapter name also used its two-line limit. Its number was centred against the complete visible title, rather than only its first line.

The chapter name also used its two-line limit. Its number was centred against the complete visible title, rather than only its first line.

This demo uses the same `\titlepage` as the opening. The metadata changes are local to that frame; your normal presentation metadata returns afterwards.

The closing command `\dasethankyou[Title]{Subtitle}` uses the same two-line limits.



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Practical IP based traffic generation for large...

Overflow demo: this subtitle contains far more explanation than the cover's two-line...

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4 Make it yours

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What to replace, and where

Start from this folder; keep the theme and its supporting assets together

File / location	Your change
template.tex: preamble	Set title, subtitle, author, institute and date.
assets/lab-logo.png	Replace the placeholder with your lab/team image.
template.tex: frames	Replace this guide with your chapters and content.
images/ or assets/	Add your figures; update their filenames in the source.
bib.bib	Replace the sample sources and update citation keys.
beamerthemeDASE.sty	Edit only when you need to change theme colours or layout.

Set your metadata and lab logo

```
\title{Your presentation title}
\subtitle{A useful subtitle}
\author[Short Name]{Your full name}
\institute[Your Lab]{Your lab / affiliation}
\date{Your event and date}

% Optional: use a different logo file.
\renewcommand{\daselablogfile}
{assets/my-lab-logo.pdf}
```

```
% Optional: use a different logo file.
\renewcommand{\daselablogofile}
{assets/my-lab-logo.pdf}
```

The easy logo replacement

Overwrite `assets/lab-logo.png` with your own transparent PNG. No source edit is required.

Sizing is automatic

The reserved box has the DASE mark's width and height. Wide, tall and square images fit inside it without stretching.

Crop excess empty margins in your image.

Optional author/institute values in square brackets control the footer.

Copy a chapter, slide and block

```
\section{Your chapter}
% The chapter page is inserted automatically.

\begin{frame}{Your slide title}
  \framesubtitle{Optional subtitle}
  \begin{block}{Your main point}
    Replace this text with your content.
  \end{block}
\end{frame}

\begin{frame}[plain]
  \dasetthankyou[Thank you]{Questions?}
\end{frame}
```

```
\section{Your chapter}
% The chapter page is inserted automatically.

\begin{frame}{Your slide title}
  \framesubtitle{Optional subtitle}
  \begin{block}{Your main point}
    Replace this text with your content.
  \end{block}
\end{frame}

\begin{frame}[plain]
  \dasetthankyou[Thank you]{Questions?}
\end{frame}
```

```
\section{Your chapter}
% The chapter page is inserted automatically.

\begin{frame}{Your slide title}
  \framesubtitle{Optional subtitle}
  \begin{block}{Your main point}
    Replace this text with your content.
  \end{block}
\end{frame}

\begin{frame}[plain]
  \dasetthankyou[Thank you]{Questions?}
\end{frame}
```

Change the environment

Use `exampleblock` or `alertblock` to switch the block's role and colours.

Keep the existing `\AtBeginSection` setup for automatic chapter pages. Use `[fragile]` on frames containing verbatim code.

Special pages use `[plain]` to omit the content-page header and footer.

Insert an image or a literal code example

```
\includegraphics[
  width=.95\linewidth,
  height=4.1cm,
  keepaspectratio
]{images/4a.jpg}
```

Replace the path. PDF is useful for vector diagrams; PNG/JPG are useful for raster images.

```
\begin{frame}[fragile]{Code example}
  \begin{verbatim}
    print("Your code goes here")
  \end{verbatim}
\end{frame}
```

Use a short snippet and explain the relevant lines beside it. TikZ figures can use a normal frame.

Run from the template folder; the bibliography requires Biber

```
pdflatex template.tex
biber template
pdflatex template.tex
pdflatex template.tex
```

The README contains the file map and build instructions. Delete the demonstration chapter and cover before sharing your own talk.

- 1 Check that your lab logo, author and date are correct.
- 2 Review any ellipses: shorten important titles so their full meaning is visible.
- 3 Check image sizes, code lines and body content for overflow.
- 4 Check citation links, references and chapter progress dots.

Example sources cited in this guide; replace them with your own

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- [1] E. R. Tufte. *The Visual Display of Quantitative Information*. Graphics Press, 1983.
- [2] T. Munzner. *Visualization Analysis and Design*. CRC Press, 2014. DOI: [10.1201/b17511](https://doi.org/10.1201/b17511).
- [3] B. Shneiderman. “The Eyes Have It: A Task by Data Type Taxonomy for Information Visualizations”. In: *Proceedings of the 1996 IEEE Symposium on Visual Languages*. 1996, pp. 336–343. DOI: [10.1109/VL.1996.545307](https://doi.org/10.1109/VL.1996.545307).



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Thank you

Replace the metadata, add your lab logo, and make the slides yours.

